to manage the accounts, acting as a pipe between the application front end and the blockchain node that hosts the accounts, as shown in figure 4.2.

> **NOTE** All the commands shown here are to be typed or copied and pasted to the command line of a *terminal window*. Pressing Enter after entry will execute the command. Also, note that the version numbers may be different when you're running npm install. That's all right; npm pulls the right versions for the required modules.

Follow these steps to install the required software packages:

1. Install the operating system:

   For Linux, download and install Ubuntu Linux LTS. You can also use CentOS, Arch Linux, OpenSUSE, or other distributions. The long-term support (LTS) version is recommended instead of the new releases for security and stability.

   For macOS, download and install Homebrew (https://brew.sh).

   For Windows, make sure that you have a 64-bit machine with the Windows 10 operating system.

2. Install the browser.

   Download Chrome from https://www.google.com/chrome, and follow setup to complete the installation process. Google Chrome should start automatically when installation is complete.